

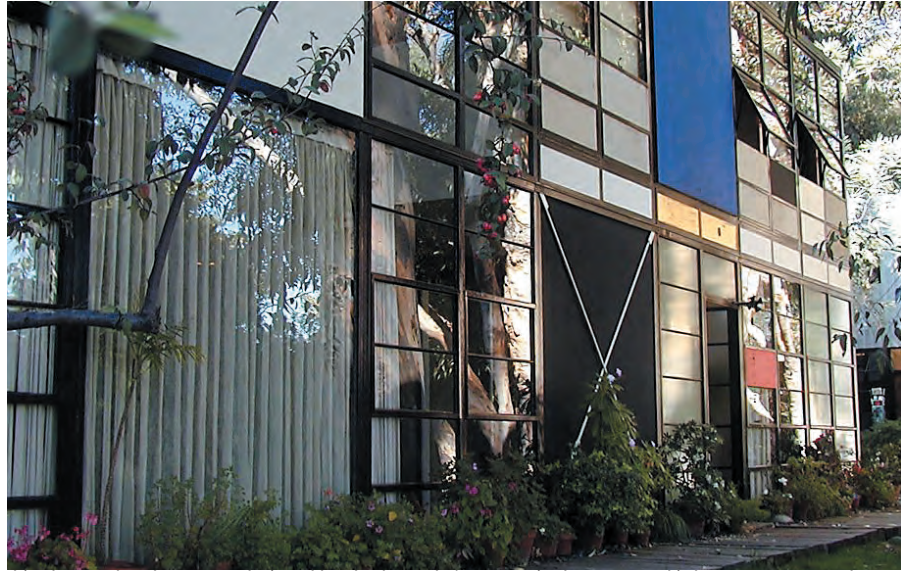
rather than academics. “We look for students with a creative bent of mind. The aspirant should also have a strong sense of aesthetics (form and colour) with a broad outlook. Divergence is most important for design and so is team work. We try to gauge all these qualities in the probable student by way of aptitude tests prior to admission. Before offering admission we also conduct a personal interview to confirm (as much as possible) he/she is genuinely talented.”

The road ahead

After graduating from design school, the obvious route is to design studios that most MNCs have set up. In fact, several Indian companies such as Onida, Videocon and TI Cycles are also setting up design studios in India and have realised the need for scientifically designed products. D J Academy of Design alumni have successfully been placed in popular companies such as Infosys, Wipro Lighting, Tata Solar, Mahindra Tech and Onida.

If you want to pursue courses abroad, institutes such as Rhode Island School of Design (Rhode Island, USA), California Institute of the Arts (California, USA), Royal

Image courtesy: ArchitectureWeek.com



This ultra modern house was designed by Charles and Ray Eames in the 1940s and is known as Case Study House #8

Design schools, in addition to imparting skills to students, perform the function of sorting probable designers. With enormous rush for admissions to design courses and the limited infrastructure in the nation, selection criteria need to be stringent and based

This is followed by an All India test in the month of April. This is known as Design Aptitude Test. The next step is a studio test and personal interview in May, where further elimination is done. Finally classes begin in the month of July.”

Placement assistance

MIT Institute of Design started in 2006 and the first PG batch graduated in March 2009. According to Mukta Khanna, “Training and Placement officer at MIT, the focus is always on innovation and new design. Last year, from over 750 applications, admissions were offered



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College of Art (London, UK) are options you could consider. Prof. Mukherjee advises you try the *best design school in the country*, work for some time and then think of going abroad for a course in design. This way, he says, “you’ll be sure of your decision and have a better understanding of the subject rather than walking blindly on a lane”.



As a designer, you'd need to have a toolkit. Industrial sculptor Paul Sandip has the following recommendations:

- Common sense, which is too uncommon
- Grey cells for sparking new connections
- Pencil (but no eraser, because every idea is worth trying out)
- Markers for attractive and informative communication.
- Rhinoceros 4.0 or any other equivalent software for 3D visualisation.
- Hypershot for photo-realistic renderings



on quality (read creativity and innovation) alone.

Deputy Registrar of MIT Vinayak Kulkarni adds, “The admission process begins in the month of November. The last date for submission of forms is January 31.



NIDUS located in the NID campus sells products designed by NID students